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Hayden's Hub: An evidence-based community hub to support **social prescribing for youth with neurodevelopmental disabilities**

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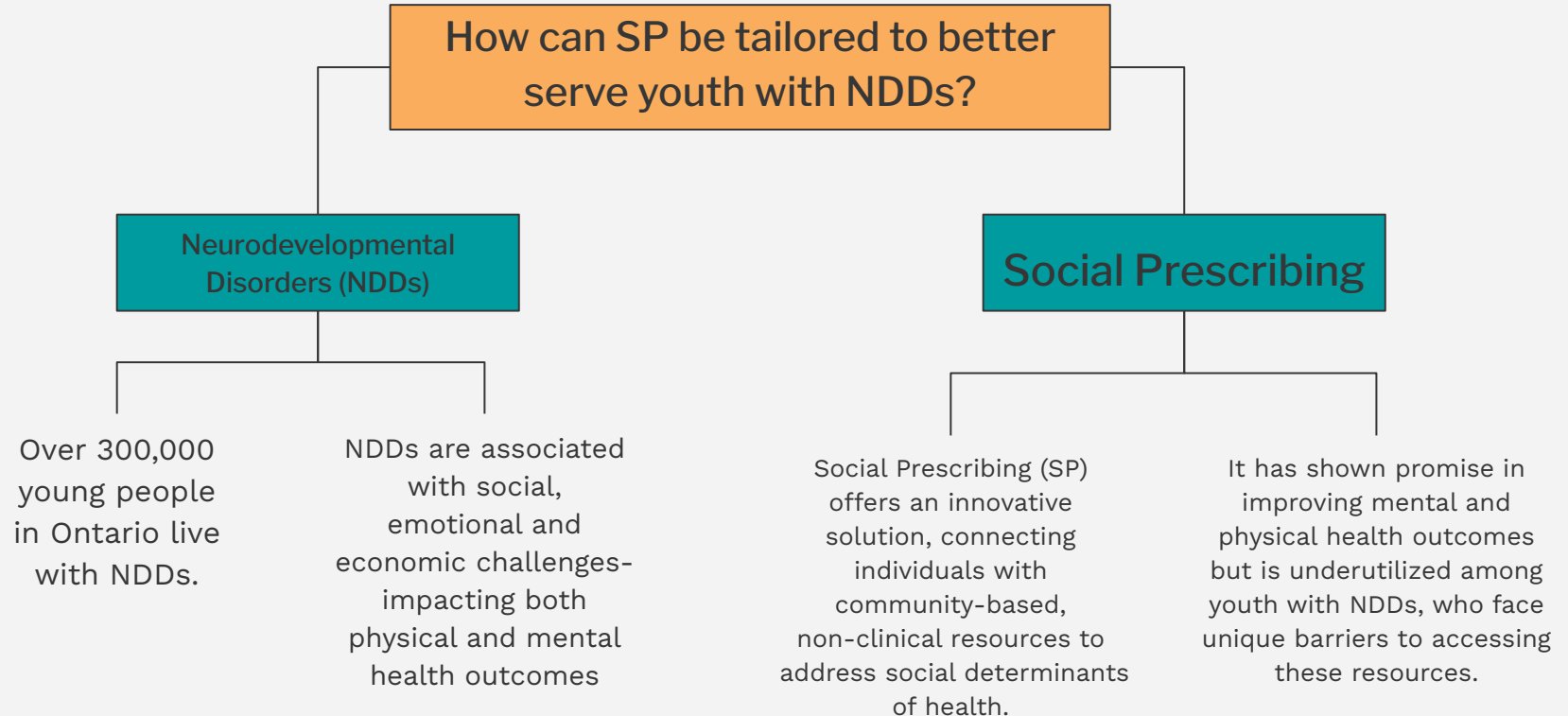
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Future Direction

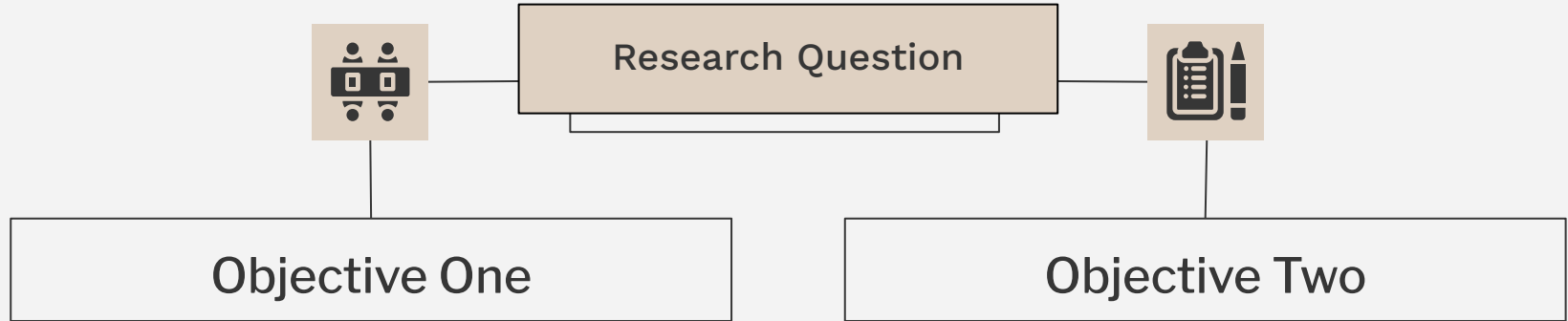
Where will Hayden's Hub go in the future?



1. Introduction



2. Research Question & Objectives



- To explore the evidence and explore how to develop a social prescribing pathway for youth with NDDs.

- Develop a pilot project- Hayden's Hub- that addresses these gaps.

2. Research Question

PICO Framework	
Patient	Youth with neurodevelopmental disabilities (e.g., autism spectrum disorder, ADHD).
Intervention	Social prescribing interventions (e.g., community engagement programs, arts, or physical activities).
Comparison	Usual care, no intervention, or alternative interventions.
Outcome	Measurable impacts such as social inclusion, mental health, quality of life, or caregiver burden

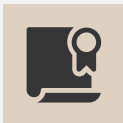


3. Methods



Rapid Review

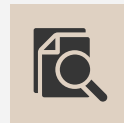
Based on the interim guidance from the Cochrane Review Methods Group.



Search Terms

Search terms included: social prescribing, social intervention and community referral

Search term variation



Databases

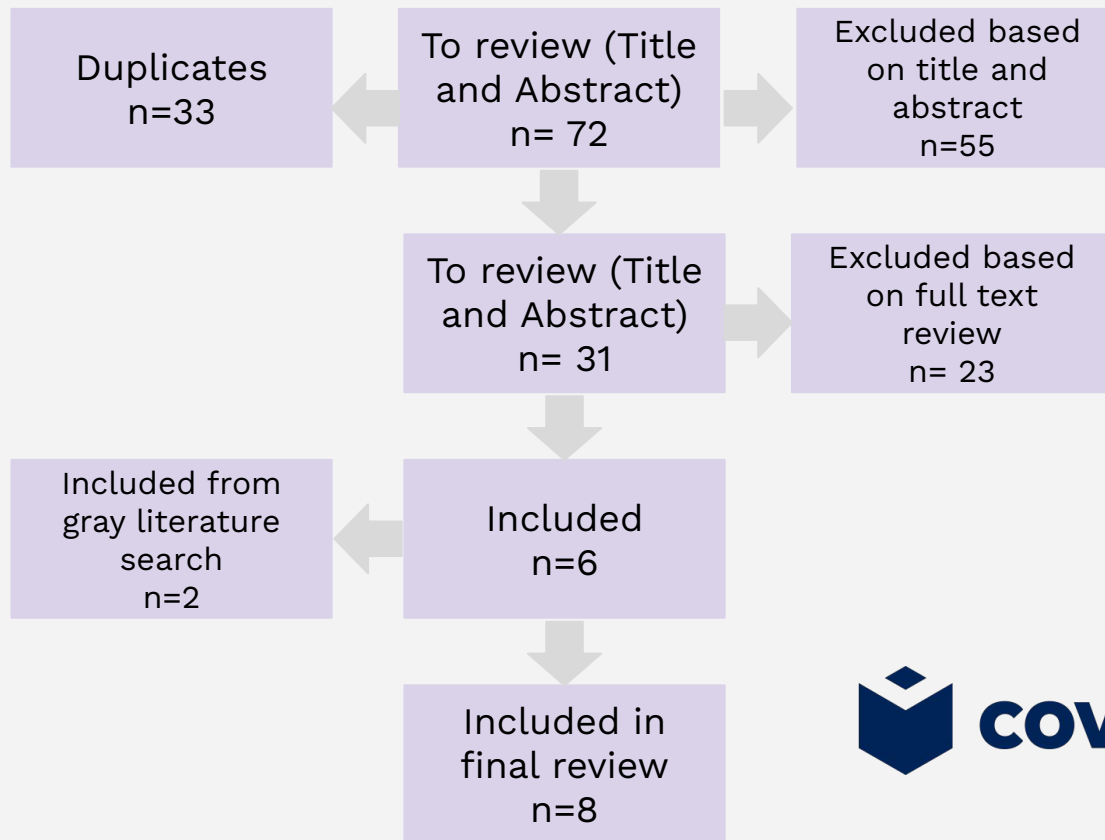
PubMed, Web of Science, EBSCOHost, Wiley, Sage

Between January 2010 to December 2024



Cochrane Methods
Rapid Reviews

Figure 1: Summary of Rapid Review Process



4. Key Findings



SP pathways have many accessibility challenges

Accessibility to SP, utilisation barriers, lack of awareness, coordination difficulties



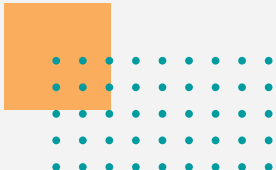
Community referrals should match with age and interests

Overall outcome improves when youth were involved in programs that matched their interests and developmental stage

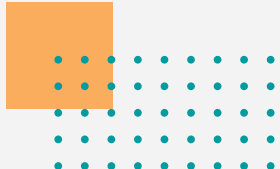
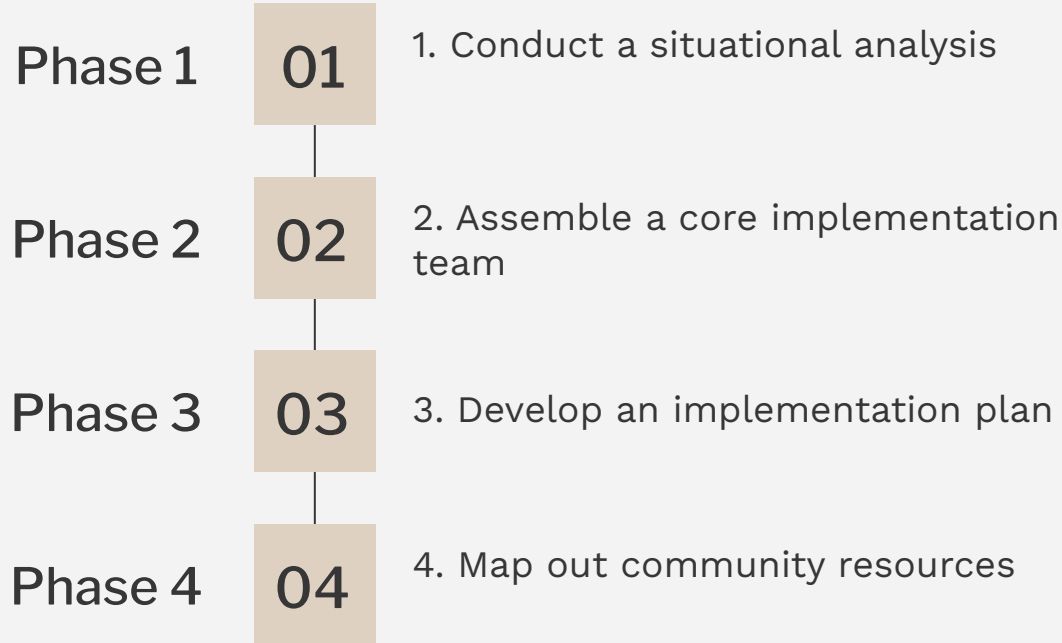


Gap in Research

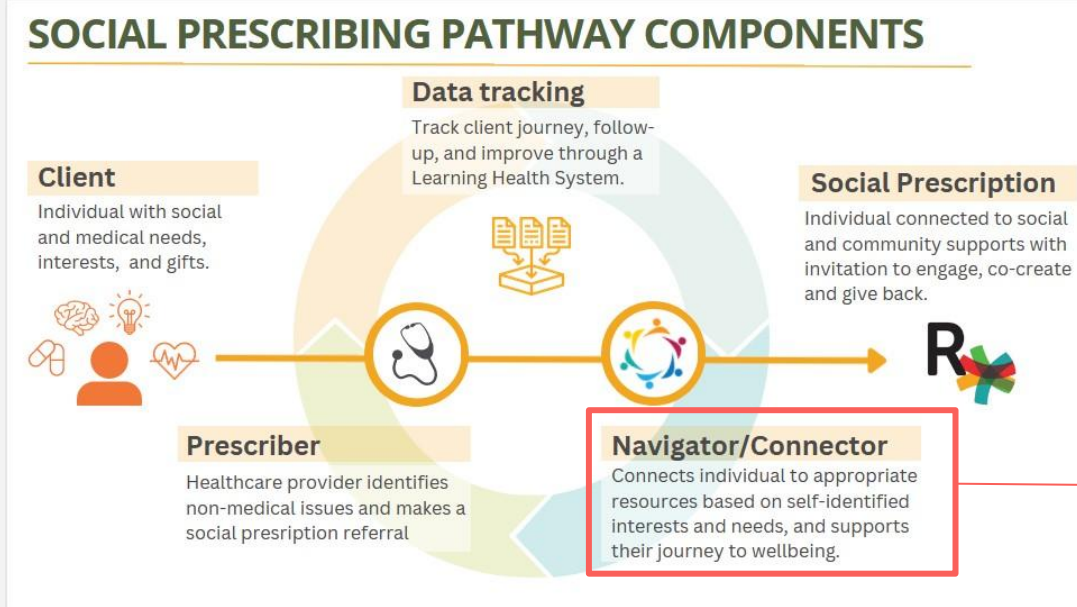
SP has shown promising results to increase sociability, feelings of inclusion and overall positive health outcomes for youth with NDDs, however there is limited research for youth specifically



SP Model: Link Workers



SP Model: Link Workers



Simply referring a client to a service is not enough—successful social prescribing actively removes barriers, connects clients with appropriate resources, and provides ongoing support to ensure meaningful outcomes.



(Social Prescribing | Alliance for Healthier Communities, 2023)

5. Future Directions: Hayden's Hub

Hayden's Hub will be a virtual community social prescribing hub in Ottawa that will connect families of youth with NDDs to community resources and support.

- Making the idea of link workers more accessible, overcoming socioeconomic barriers
- Promotion of accessible, local community resources
- Potential to increase feelings of inclusion and builds social skills- improving overall wellbeing





Hayden's Hub at CUCOH 2025

Hayden's Hub: An Evidence-Based Community Hub to Support Social Prescribing for Youth With Neurodevelopmental Disabilities

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Introduction: Social prescribing (SP) is an innovative healthcare approach that connects individuals with local, non-clinical services addressing social determinants of health, bridging gaps between primary care and community resources. While evidence demonstrates that SP enhances mental and physical health, its accessibility for youth with neurodevelopmental disabilities (NDDs) remains underexplored. This gap underscores the need for SP models tailored to the needs of this population.

Methods: A rapid review was conducted to explore Ontario's SP landscape and identify strategies for improving accessibility for youth with NDDs. Following Cochrane Review Methods Group guidelines, searches were performed across Medline EBSCOhost, PsychInfo, Wiley, and Sage databases. The search, covering publications from January 2010 to September 2024, included both peer-reviewed and grey literature. Findings were summarized using content analysis for descriptive synthesis.

Results: The review identified a significant gap in SP research for youth with NDDs, particularly challenges faced when accessing services through primary healthcare pathways. These insights guided the development of Hayden's Hub, a pilot project in Ottawa designed to bridge this gap by offering social prescribing tools tailored to youth with special needs.

Conclusion: By promoting SP, the project adopts an upstream approach to social determinants of health, emphasizing the need to understand how youth with NDDs experience SP pathways and identifying necessary adaptations. Hayden's Hub aims to improve access to community resources and enhance mental health outcomes for this population.

Funding: This project was funded by Canada Service Corps (CSC) at Employment and Social Development Canada and GLOCAL Canada.

Out of 223 submissions, the Hayden's Hub project was chosen to be **one of eight** oral presenters at the **Canadian Undergraduate Conference on Healthcare**.

I got to visit Kingston and present my work in front of 150 undergraduate students. Social prescribing is an effective healthcare model that targets the social determinants of health and it was an honour to share this with future healthcare professionals!





Photo Memories from CUCOH 2025





Plans for 2025



Our goals for this year is to have our **manuscript published** and to have a **working website by September 2025**. We have formed an executive team consisting of seven undergraduate students from **Queen's University, University of Ottawa and Carleton University**. Amongst our team, we have four members that have **lived experiences** with neurodevelopmental disabilities through various facets (caregiving, lived experience, etc).

Furthermore, we are proud to be partnering with **Carleton Blueprint** that connects student web developers and designers to nonprofit organizations. With the help of our technology lead, Anjali, Carleton Blueprint will help bring Hayden's Hub to a website.





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Thank you

Do you have any questions?

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